

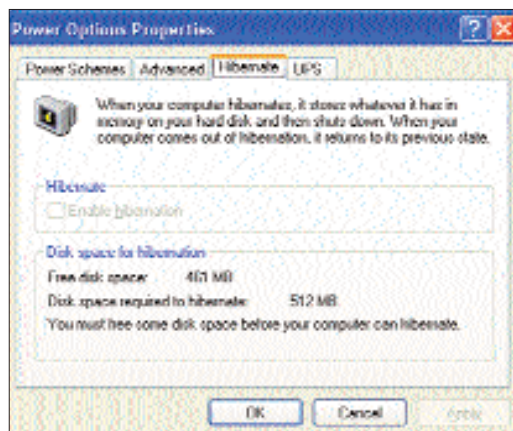
Insomnia

Q I have an AMD Athlon64 2800+, an MSI RS480 motherboard with 512 MB RAM, and Windows XP Pro. I have been using the hibernate feature instead of shutting down my computer. Of late, the low disk space warning on the C drive has started appearing, and the hibernate option appears to be disabled.

Pradip Ghosh

A When an XP-based computer goes into Hibernate mode, it creates a file called hiberfil.sys in the root directory. The size of this file is, of course, equal to that of the system RAM, because XP stores the contents of the RAM in this file.

In your case, because of the low disk space, there is not enough space to create this file, so



The Hibernate option gets disabled due to low disk space

the Hibernate feature is disabled. To re-enable it, free up enough space—512 MB in your case—on your C drive.

Startup In Slo-Mo

Q Every time my PC boots, it takes around 30 to 40 seconds to detect the combo drive before proceeding. Then, when the XP welcome screen appears, it takes another 2 to 3 minutes to start Windows. The hard disk activity LED is on during all this time.

Priyesh Kanodia

A The problem could just be caused by a loose data or power cable. Remove the cables and clean the contact areas using a brush. Do the same at the contact area of the hard drive and the combo drive. Then, run a thorough disk scan of your hard drive to verify if there are any cross-linked files, or if any bad sectors have developed.

To do this, open My Computer, right-click on each drive, select Properties, and click on the Tools tab. Under Error Checking, click on the Check Now button. In the Check Disk window that opens, select “Automatically fix file system errors” and “Scan for and attempt recovery of bad sectors,” and start the disk checking process. If problems are found and fixed, you’re good to go.

Sounding Off

Q My Samsung 40 GB 7200 rpm hard drive has recently started making weird sounds—they sound like “kit kit,” and the computer is not able to boot into Windows. I connected it to a friend’s PC: while his PC detected the hard drive, it could detect only two of the four partitions. Can NDD recover the data on the other two partitions?

Harish Negi

A The kind of sound you’re talking about generally indicates that the media—the disk platter—has suffered physical damage. In your case, since at least some data is accessible, it seems the partition table of your drive has become corrupt. Many disk utilities such as Disk Scan and Norton Disk Doctor can attempt to repair such errors, but there is no guarantee that the data will be recovered. Hence, before running such utilities, it is better to run data recovery utilities such as OnTrack Easy Recovery Professional, or one of the utilities from R-Studio, to maximise the chances of recovering data.

If your data is recovered, back it up and then run the disk scanning utilities to repair the errors in the partition table. You should be able to use the drive. But even then, the sound from your drive is not something that can be ignored—you’ll likely need to replace it.

Nero Says Nyet

Q I have an LG GCC-4240N DVD-Writer. My computer has Windows XP and Nero 6.3.1.15 installed. Whenever I begin writing a CD or DVD, after completing 2 to 3 per cent, Nero reports an “Invalid write state” error, and a castor results.

Manikant Patel

A There is not one definite reason due to which this error occurs, but you can try downloading and install the latest ASPI layer from Adaptec. Also try using a different brand of media. Look for and download the latest firmware for your drive off the Internet and upgrade to that version. If even that doesn’t help, your DVD-Writer has developed a hardware problem, and you’ll have to replace it.

Download The DLL

Q I have Windows XP installed. When I try to install eDonkey, I get an error: “MSVCP71.DLL was not found.” What could be the problem?

Chirag Bhunatar

A This could happen either if MSVCP71.DLL is missing, or if it got unregistered. Search for the file in the System32 directory. If you find it, go to Start > Run, type in “regsvr32 C:\Windows\System32\MSVCP71.dll”, and hit [Enter] (assuming that Windows is installed in C:\Windows). This will register the file. If the file is missing, you can download a zipped version from www.dll-files.com/dllindex/dll-files.shtml?msvcp71. Register the DLL as explained above.